

Title: Reached Challenger after 14 years and why you should play Twisted Fate to climb

Score:

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Hi everyone, recently I got challenger for the first time since I started playing this game since season 2. I will probably lose it after tomorrow's reset because the cutoff goes up insanely fast but that's besides the point.

<https://op.gg/lol/summoners/na/%ED%91%B8%EB%A5%B8%20%ED%95%98%EB%8A%98-9029>

I'm here to talk about why I think you should play Twisted Fate and why I think he is a fairly underrated champion when people are discussing champ pools. I think people have this misconception of TF that he is a passive champ that just tries get through lane without interacting with the enemy laner and then he functions as a support later on by just stun carding people. This is far from the truth, the best TF players play very aggressive and play to win lane. If TF has a smooth early game, he can play to push waves and assassinate enemy carries with the item and tempo leads he can generate from his increased passive gold income.

****WHY SHOULD YOU PLAY TWISTED FATE?****

* Straight forward kit, mechanically simple to pilot. I am almost 30 years old and I have no problem playing TF. If you see me on Yasuo or Yone you would probably report me. This is the perfect champ for geriatric gamers (most of you) or for people who don't want to use all their brainpower for mechanics and just want to focus on macro.

* He's really fun. The dopamine hit from knowing you won a game because you found good ults and good gold cards is unmatched.

* He is VERY good. I've been playing a lot of TF for the past few seasons and I think he is probably in one of the best states he's been in a while. His items are good and the midlane role quest giving you upgraded defensive boots is insanely good vs hard matchups. The enhanced recall also plays really well into his gameplay patterns of pushing waves and playing for tempo.

* He's just freaking cool

First thing to get out of the way is that you should ban Yasuo. There are a lot of Yasuo otps in soloq at every elo and the matchup is very unplayable, don't bother. Just ban him if you can. If Yasuo is already banned, I recommend banning Mel, it is impossible to lane vs that champ but at least it's not Yasuo.

The most obvious thing to keep in mind is that, yes, TF is not the highest damage champion. There are many games where I am dealing 3rd or 4th most damage because that is just how the champion functions but there are also games where I am dealing the most damage in challenger lobbies - it all depends on how the games play out.

Before I get into general tips, here are the three setups you usually run

****SETUPS****

* Spellbook (resolve/sorcery secondary) - run this into lanes where you are either unable to interact or don't want to interact with the enemy laner (Yasuo, morg, vex, viktor, mel, etc)

* Electrocute (resolve secondary) - run this into champions that stick to you to deal damage (Sylas,

Katarina, Fizz, Yone, etc)

* Comet (resolve secondary) - run this into mages where you can actually trade with them without getting blasted and you can actually contest push

You can run flash tp with all of these setups but I prefer to take ignite when I'm running electrocute or comet

For shards, run attackspeed, movespeed, and either flat or scaling health (I usually run flat)

Item builds are very interesting because most people default to RoA and gunblade has been picking up popularity but I actually believe that rocketbelt is the best first item for TF. Like gunblade, you don't get mana from the item so you will have to be more careful with mana management than if you built roa but I believe that the trade off of having the rocketbelt active to dodge skillshots / ganks and to get in range to stun people is more than worth it. Roa is still a very safe option that is fine in every game. The early catalyst buy that builds out of double ruby crystals makes it very hard for assassins to kill you early, preventing them from snowballing. I think roa is good to build when you're vs an assassin and want to survive or if the enemy has unavoidable engage that you can't really avoid (Yasuo/diana mid jungle type shit)

Whichever the case, the rest of your core should look the same every game

Rocketbelt/gunblade/roa - lichbane (build the aether wisp component first) - rfc -

hourglass/bandlepipes/damage if you're ahead

I see a lot of people building rfc second on TF and this is BAD. Yes, TF as a champ spikes insanely hard at rfc because the increased range to gold card is game changing. No, you should NOT buy it second. First item + lichbane makes it so that you can almost instantly clear waves so that you always have good tempo and you can be wherever you need to be on the map. Without lichbane, your waveclear becomes SIGNIFICANTLY worse and you lose out on both gold and opportunities in the game because you were too slow at pushing waves. If you are ahead you can build damage like deathcap etc after your core but I usually find myself building hourglass so I can make very aggressive ults into the enemy team to gold card and hourglass to make picks. Bandlepipes is actually a very underrated item on TF and I think it is quite good. If you're vs mixed damage teams and you have auto attackers on your team who want attack speed, you should build this. The item is VERY cheap and all the stats and effects synergize very well with TF. Another itemization tweak that I do differently from other TF players I've watched is that I really like to buy elixir of iron late game. Not only does it make TF bulkier and harder to cc so it's easier for you to run at people to stun, it ALSO makes it easier for your teammates to catchup to you when you go in for a flash gold card etc.

****Gameplay****

Without getting too into the minutia of every matchup, you should actually be willing to fight vs champs like sylas, fizz, etc early game. There is an old dopa video where he talks about how fizz lost the lane to his TF at level 1 when he autoed a creep but that video is maybe a decade old at this point and the game and the systems have changed since then. Nowadays, it is actually quite

advantageous to slow push into champs like sylas and fizz and just stand your ground and fight them to the death with electro ignite boneplating while inside your minion wave. I promise you, they will be surprised by your damage. I've solo killed challenger sylas fizz ekko yone etc otps at level 2/3 because they weren't familiar with the matchup and just expected to be able to beat down TF early.

Early game you should have an idea of how you want to manage your waves.

* Vs a lot of melee champs, you should want to 2 wave crash into playing the bounce back. The main thing to watch out for here is that if you play the 2 wave crash too slow, the enemy laner will hit level 3 before you as their tower will also be killing your wave and you will get all inned and die. The main benefit to doing this is that most melee champs are dogwater level 1 but will own you at level 3 with all their skills. So by slowpushing 2 waves into a freeze on the bounceback, you make it so that the wave is on your side of the lane by level 3, making the game much more playable for you. This is NOT possible vs someone like Yasuo, he will beat your ass at every point in the game and the lane is not playable without jungle help.

* Vs mages you can contest like Ryze, Orianna, etc you should look to aggressively red card them, either directly or by splashing the aoe off a creep while you contest push. The reason you run comet in these lanes is because if you run spellbook, they will beat you down in lane and there won't really be openings for you to fight back, your jungler to help, or to win 2v2s if you haven't already been chipping away at them with comet scorch. This is also why I like running ignite. You don't run ignite for laning power, you run it so that when there's a 2v2/3v3 in the river, you can squeeze out a LITTLE bit of extra juice to secure a kill and snowball the game.

****Base Timers****

Everyone knows that the new homeguards this season made it really easy to keep up in lane because you can base and you'll be back in lane really fast. Regardless, you should still try to base on the precannon waves to minimize xp and gold loss. The timers are:

2:50

4:20

5:50

7:20

8:50

10:20

11:50

13:20

etc

(Shove the wave that arrives at these times and recall when you need a base)

****Mid game****

You should NOT always fast push waves. When towers are down and the map is dark, if you try to fast push a side wave, you will PROBABLY get ganked and die, even if you have vision. You need to be intentional with deciding when to freeze or slow push side waves (you'll notice that players like chovy and faker do this a lot when you watch their vods). The goal is to maximize your gold and impact on the map, not spend more time on the enemy's side of the map or wandering around because you are homeless because you can't touch a wave or you'll die. But when you do have vision of the enemy team, it's very common that you'll be able to push 2 waves on side, wait til someone shows up to catch the wave, and then you can port mid for a pick.

****VERY IMPORTANT THINGS TO KEEP IN MIND OR YOU WILL LOSE A LOT OF GAMES AND BE MAD****

* Twisted Fate is a very team oriented champion. Yes, you do need to play for yourself so you can maximize your gold income and get to your three item rfc spike faster, but you also need to know when to play for your team. The BIG BIG BIG thing that made my climb so much easier is that I keep one eye on my own jungler for all of the early game. If you see that your jungler is about to finish clearing his camps and is going to recall, you should push your wave and recall too. You NEED to be playing on the same timers as your jungler. If you base while your jungler wants to do something on the map or vice versa, you are GRIEFING and you will lose a LOT of games. You might ask, well then why shouldn't the jungler play around me, why do I need to play around my jungler? That's because you're playing around minion waves that arrive every 30 seconds and someone will almost always be there to catch them. The jungler has to play around his camp respawn timers or he is fucking himself, so it is VERY IMPORTANT that you play around your jungler and be ready to fight when he is.

* Conversely, TF is not a champ that has to perma roam or perma ult to be successful. You are a scaling champ, once you hit 3 items (roa/gunblade/belt, lichbane, rfc) you are a monster who has solid damage with insane pick potential. You need to maximize your income. If you see that your enemy laner is walking bot on a ward and your bot lane is about to die, don't ult to try and salvage a situation that is 90% doomed, just push the wave and get plates. Ideally you don't give the enemy laner a timer to roam but that's not feasible to do every game so you have to take the guaranteed gains. If you feel like you are constantly coinflipping ults and roams and you're playing fast paced ALL the time as TF, you are probably doing something wrong. There are many games where I don't press ult a single time for the first ten minutes of the game simply because there is no reason for me to ult. You have to be very careful with your first ult usage because it often sets the tempo for the

game. If you get a kill, you start snowballing. If you don't get a kill, you probably lost xp and gold from being away from your wave and now you have no map presence until your ult is back. Don't be afraid about playing the game slow, just play methodically and you will win a lot of games.

* Once you fast push a lane, you don't have to stick around and look for stuff. You can instantly recall and run down another lane and lane gank with ult. This really catches people off guard, because they just saw you on a wave somewhere else on the map but suddenly you're ulting on top of them instead of catching the mid wave. You can get a LOT of free kills this way. Here's me doing it vs doublelift recently:

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=11D_QfT1H8Q

He just saw that there was a big fight top lane and he expects everyone to reset but I based and immediately ran bot instead of catching the mid wave, leading to a free kill. You can do this very often in your games, and it WILL catch people off guard.

****Some general tips:****

* You need to utilize your w auto cancel well in melee matchups, especially if you're running electrocute. You can run at a lot of champions level 1 and just auto w auto to proc electrocute and instantly nuke them. If you do not use the auto cancel, your electrocute will NOT proc, which is why this is so important. Here's me doing it vs Quantum's yone, you can see how strong the trade is - <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BHCjxWXCdZE>

* Do not push q randomly. In hard matchups, you need to save your q to last hit creeps from range. If your q is on cd when you need it farm a cannon, you are screwed.

* It is fine to ult for vision around objectives. If both teams are in a drake/baron standoff and you don't see key members of the enemy team, it is perfectly fine to press r and try and spot them to see if they're trying to flank or assassinate someone.

* In higher elo games, people will ward the lane to see which side of the map TF is roaming towards. It is good to buy early sweeper in these games to clear vision and keep people guessing where you are.

Even when you don't have ult, it's very effective if you fog towards one side of the map because the enemy team won't know it's on cd and will feel pressured to play safe as a result. Very helpful for bailing out a losing sidelane because suddenly the enemy lane has to back off because they think you're going to ult them.

* I think Underworld TF is a pay to lose skin because the cards on his W are a little translucent and it makes it harder to instantly lock the card you want if it shows. Might be a skill issue on my part though.

--- TOP COMMENTS ---

[Comment 1 | Score: 105]

i think TF is harder to play than you make it sound but honestly this was a good writeup with great advice

[Comment 2 | Score: 27]

Honestly thank you for not framing this as an AMA and just sharing helpful game advice

[Comment 3 | Score: 25]

Why do people think people in their 30s somehow magically lose their motor skills? Im 25 but I swear if you take care of your body, your mechanical skill in games and physical activities wont degrade with age, but even if you dont, 30 is fucking young!

[Comment 4 | Score: 10]

Love me some TF. Really should boot it up.

Is there a tip to be better at handling W? I remember the saying with the continuous cycle and that you can keep it going in your head. Do you do this? Or do you just pay attention to it when pressing it?

[Comment 5 | Score: 7]

Hitting chall is crazy and im happy that tf worked for you but he wouldn't be it for me. I think in general people just need to play what they enjoy because if youre enjoying to play a champ good you're already on a good track for high elo